towns and cities in this region was fairly gender-balanced and gradual. The recent growth of Pune, Bangalore and Hyderabad was largely based on migration from other urban locations and therefore these cities did not experience intense male-dominated labour migrations from rural areas as witnessed in Mumbai, Kolkata, Delhi and, more recently, Surat. The Malnad and Coorg coffee plantations and Nilgiri tea plantations in the south were important destinations of the Great Indian Migration Wave, but they often attracted labour from the coastal plains. Migration to the Kolar Gold Fields near Bangalore was mostly family-based and not very large in magnitude. Today, there are important tracts of short-term seasonal migration such as west Odisha, Raichur in Karnataka, Khandesh in Maharashtra and Mahbubnagar in Telangana which are slowly showing signs of joining the semi-permanent movements of the Great Indian Migration Wave.

Like the Deccan, much of west, central, and north-east India never became important source regions of the migration wave. Rajasthan has only recently emerged as a major hotspot for remittance-based migration towards Gujarat, Delhi and other major cities, but historically, labour outmigration was limited. Assam in the Northeast emerged as a major magnet for over a million Indians by the early 20th century by providing jobs on tea estates and construction works, among others. Five populous source region clusters in the hinterlands deserve particular attention: the Bhojpuri-speaking tracts of east Uttar Pradesh and west Bihar, Jharkhand, parts of Chhattisgarh, east Punjab and the Himalayan belt.

Density was a burden not only for Saran but the entire Bhojpuri-speaking belt, and this would in turn lead to similar migration destinies if not similar destinations. Their destinations were purab but many of the erstwhile districts of the eastern United Provinces, now Uttar Pradesh, such as Ballia, Ghazipur, Azamgarh, Fyzabad, Basti, Gonda, Gorakhpur, Banaras, Mirzapur and Jaunpur would became key recruiting areas for overseas migration to Mauritius, Fiji, Suriname, South Africa (Natal), the Caribbean and many other parts of the world in the late 19th century. Apart from density, this region also had pre-existing migratory links in military service